What is it all about?

Solving Paradox of Choice for Amazon Prime Video

What is paradox of choice?

It is an observation that having many options to choose from, rather than making people happy and ensuring they get what they want, can cause them stress and problematise decision-making.

About Amazon Prime

It is a subscription-based streaming service offered by Amazon, providing users with a wide variety of television shows, movies, documentaries, and more, including Amazon Originals.

Market Share: 21% in India

Subscriber base: 12.4 Million in India

Goal

To solve the 'paradox of choice' problem through a differentiated product experience for Amazon Prime Video resulting in long-term stickiness of the customer and thereby maximising revenues.

Assumption

Infinite Tech Bandwidth, Region: India

Revenue Streams

Prime Membership: Prime Video is included as part of Amazon's broader Prime subscription, which offers various benefits

Prime Video Channels: Subscribers can add content from over 100 premium and specialty channels, such as HBO, Showtime, and Starz, for additional monthly fees.

Standalone Subscription: Amazon offers Prime Video as a standalone subscription service as well.

Rent or Buy: Prime Video offers users the option to rent or buy movies and TV shows.

Insights from survey

Validating the Paradox

59.70% of respondents said they leave the platform when unable to decide or doesn't like what they have chosen to watch

80.41% of respondents say they struggle to decide on what to watch

21.07% of respondents say they "always" struggle to decide on what to watch

23.29% of respondents believe they spend a lot of time deciding the content

Going in depth to understand the decision making behaviour of users who end up with decision fatigue

77.25% of who described their daily routine as "Busy and Fast paced" said they struggle to decide on what to watch.

20.8% of these said they "always" struggle to decide what to watch.

61.80% of these busy respondents mentioned that "Limited time makes choosing harder"

45.83% of these busy respondents who believed that "limited time makes choosing harder" said that they end up "Re-watching" a favourite. **52%** said "they switched to another streaming service."

33.87% of who described their daily routine as "Busy and Fast paced" said "they look for what to watch on their own".

44.88% of these people believe "they spend moderate amount of time" deciding what to watch, **27.56%** believe they spend "a lot of time" deciding what to watch.

33.87% of who described their daily routine as "Busy and Fast paced" said they look for what to watch on their own.

34.4% of busy respondents said they prefer social media recommendations.

41.87% of busy respondents said they prefer friend's or family recommendation.

What is the true problem?

Users face significant challenges in making swift, high-quality decisions regarding selection of content when navigating Prime Video. Users who select content on their own end up disliking it in most cases. The reason users are not able to select a content to watch on their own is due to various emotional barriers, including the fear of missing out on superior shows, a lack of confidence in their selections, and the apprehension that they may waste time on unenjoyable content. This combination of factors contributes to decision fatigue, user spending more time finding the content, resulting in users either reverting to re-watching familiar shows or, out of frustration, abandoning the platform altogether.

Who is facing the problem?

Rohit, 29 y/o, Software Engineer, lives in Tier 1

Lifestyle

- Leads a busy and fast paced life, juggling work and social activities.

Media Consumption Habits

- Watches on Phone, Laptop.
- Tends to look up shows or movies themselves.
- Influenced by reviews on social media and friend's recommendations.

Streaming Frequency

- Few Times a week

How do we know it is a real problem?

Survey findings indicate that **about 80%** of users face decision fatigue at least once while 20% face decision fatigue always. Also, **78% of busy respondents** who selected the content on their own believe they didn't like it. About **60% of users said they leave the media platform** if they are unable to find the content quickly.

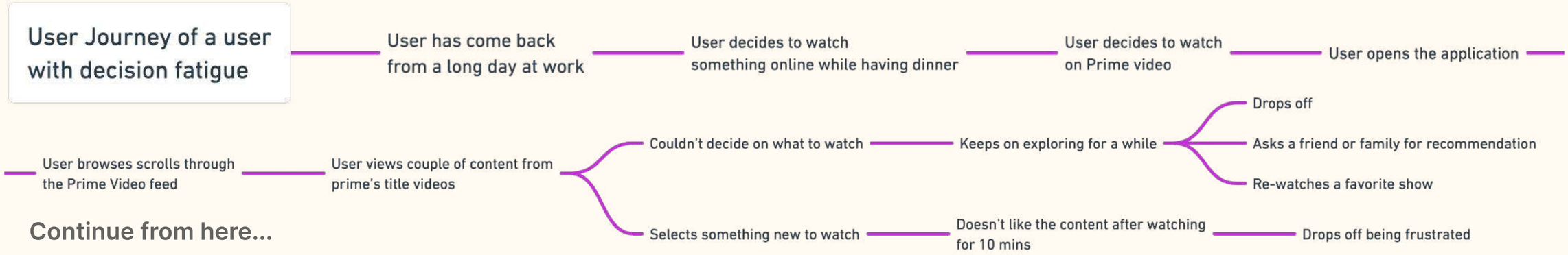
Value Generated

For Users

User will be able to make quality decisions faster leading to higher satisfaction.

For Business

Increased watch time metrics, as users will watch rather than finding content. Increased active users, as users will find content easily and stick to the platform. Decreased churn.



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Catching Drop-off Intent

What it is?

A feature that detects when a user is taking longer than the average time to select content. At this point, the system will automatically suggest re-watching a previously enjoyed show.

How it solves problem?

It was found that 45% of the people end up re-watching the previously enjoyed show. The solution counts on the similar user behaviour for those 52% users who dropped off when they were unable to find a show.

IMDb like review system

What it is?

Enabling users to submit detailed reviews of shows they've watched, with a minimum requirement of 200 words. Upon submission, reviews will undergo evaluation by Amazon's system for quality, relevance, community guidelines, inappropriate content, and spam.

How it solves problem?

This approach is designed to foster more meaningful contributions, thereby enhancing viewer confidence in the review system and supporting more informed decision-making.

Amazon Clips

What it is?

User can view most engaging 30 seconds clips of shows/movies on the platform.
User can option to view the whole content if they like the clips or move on to other clips.

How it solves problem?

Significant % of users preferred social media recommendations. This is believed to happen because it helps users evaluate the content and eventually make a decision.

Amazon Friends

What it is?

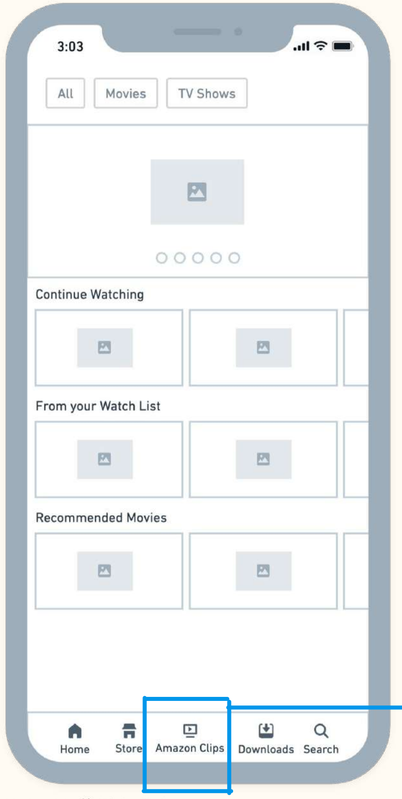
User can add friends from their contact or invite via email/phone.
User can view what their social circle is upto.
User can also view the watchlist of the circle.
Social circle can also help enhance the recommendation algorithm
User can recommend shows to their circle

How it solves problem?

34% of busy respondents said they prefer social media recommendations. While about 41% prefer their friend's or family recommendations.

Solution	Reach	User Impact	Business Impact	Confidence	Effort
Amazon Friends RICE=2.8	3 Targets socially active users	5 Fosters community and shared viewing experiences.	3 Can increase retention through social engagement.	3 There's plenty of consumer social apps out there	5 It's almost a social platform to create from scratch
Amazon Clips RICE=5.6 Selected	4 It's relatively easy to reach audience with story like clips	5 Enhances content discovery and social interaction.	5 Helps with content discovery hence reducing churn and increasing watch time	3 User adoption might lead to user getting stuck in scroll loop	3 Involves create a new content format.
IMDb like review system RICE=5.6 Selected	5 Reviews will be associated to all the content on prime	4 Helps user make informed decision about selection	4 Increases engagement and trust	4 Given proven model of IMDb	3 Plenty of review system infra already there for amazon
Catching drop off intent RICE=3	3 Targets only potential drop offs	3 Only helps user when they dropping off	3 Helps retaining dropping users	3 Dependency on accuracy of intent catching	4 Predictive modelling and integration

Amazon Clips



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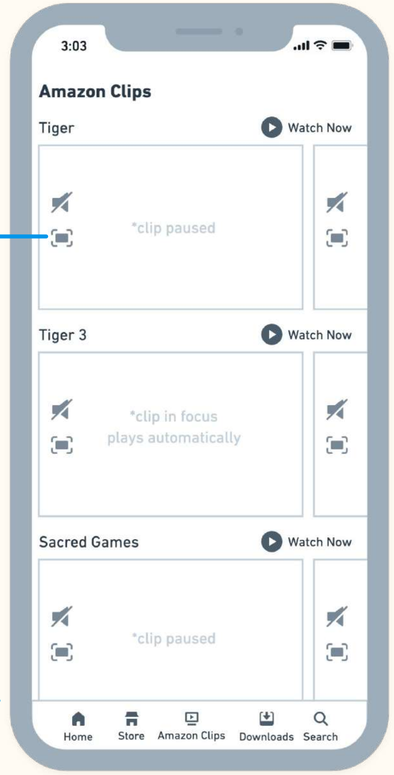
User can tap on "Amazon Clips from the bottom nav



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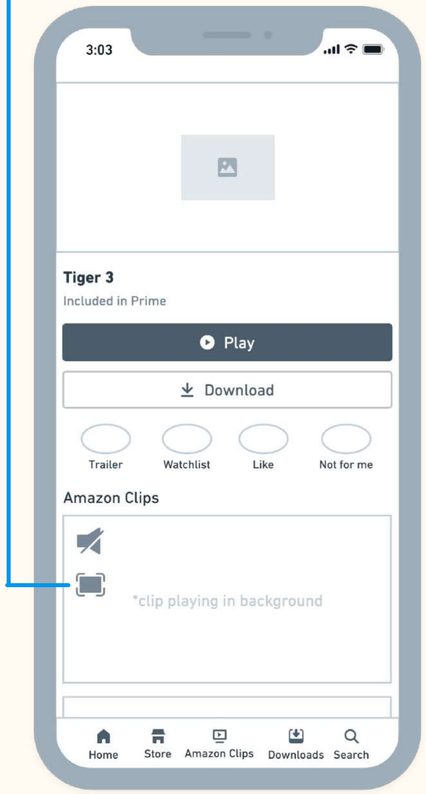
1. User can view clips grouped by movies/shows
2. Clip in focus plays automatically



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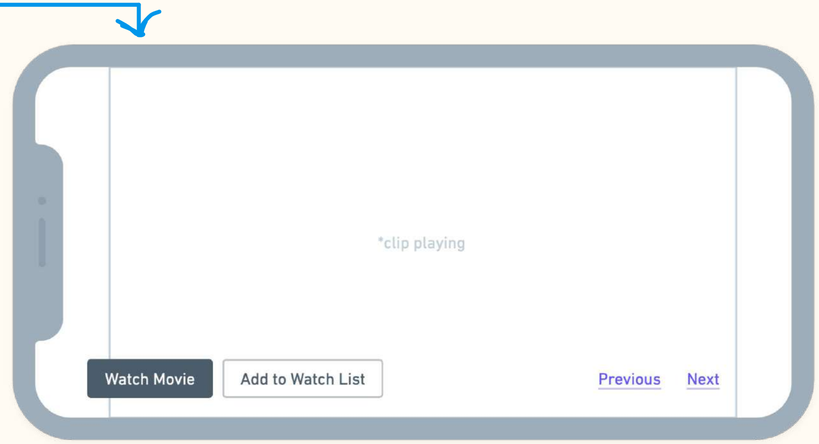
1. User can also view the content specific clips on the content drill down screen



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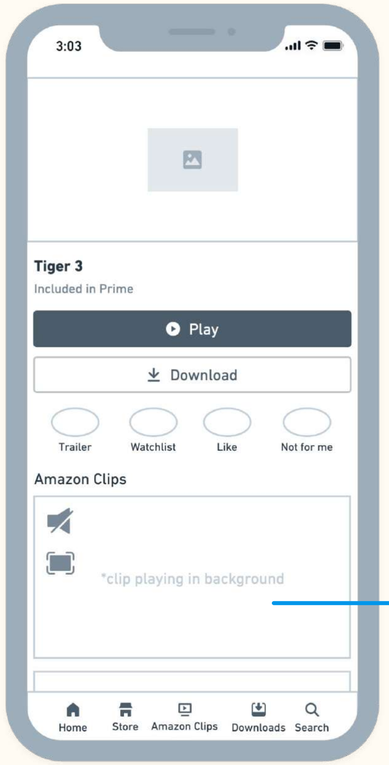
1. User can tap on view in landscape mode icon to view the clip.
2. User can tap on next or previous to go forward
3. User can tap on watch movie to watch the complete content
4. The clip moves forward as it ends.

IIMDb like review system



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User can scroll down to view the reviews

User can view the ratings, partial view of the review. User can also like or dislike the review by tapping on helpful/ not helpfull button

1. User can enter their rating by selecting the star
2. User needs to add a title
3. User needs to write a review that is min 200
4. User can also convey if the review has spoillers

To validate Amazon Clips

Avg . Watch time of users who viewed amazon clips

Total minutes spent watching content by users who completely viewed at least one amazon clip/ Total number of users who viewed at least one amazon clip

Compare it with cohort of users who don't view amazon clips

Drop off rate for users who watched amazon clips

Number of users who watched at least one amazon clip but didn't watch any show/ Number of users who watched at least one amazon clip

Compare it with cohort of users who didn't view amazon clip

Content Viewed Per User

(Number of unique content titles watched per user who viewed at least one amazon clip - Number of unique content titles watched per user pre-implementation) / Number of unique content titles watched per user pre-implementation * 100%

To validate IMDB like ratings

Decision Time

Avg. decision time post implementation

Compare it with cohort of users pre implementation. This metric shall be tracked in long run.

Conversion Rate

Number of content session started after viewing reviews/Number of review views by users